

LaunchSafe: The Risk Negotiation Game

Focuses on safe delivery amidst complex trade-offs.

1. Understand the Scenario (3min)

Read the context and review the exposed risks.

Discuss with your team which risks are most critical to your project.

2. Receive Your Budget

Each team starts with \$10,000 (virtual currency).

Use it to bid during the auction. (On every new Scenario you'll get new pool of \$10000)

3. Risk Mitigation Auction (10min)

The facilitator will present one mitigation strategy at a time.

Raise your hand to bid — the highest bidder wins.

You can buy max 3 mitigations as you want within budget.

4. Risk Simulation (5min)

The facilitator will simulate which risks occur.

If you purchased the right mitigation, you avoid the risk.

If not, your team will face a penalty (loss of points or impact).

5. Debrief - Explain your strategy to get Bonus (max 1 min)

Reward Points

Criteria	Points
Risk avoided due to mitigation	+10
Risk occurred but unmanaged	-10
Budget remaining	5 point per \$1000
Creative or well-justified strategy	+5 bonus

Scenario 1

You only have \$10,000 in your risk budget.

Your teams are building a mobile payment app scheduled to launch in 4 weeks at a national fintech event.

The CEO demands every promised feature must go live.

Yesterday, the government introduced new data compliance laws that could affect your app's payment flow and storage practices.

Risk ID	Description
R1	Data compliance regulation may block app release.
R2	Integration with payment gateway is unstable.
R3	High workload is causing team burnout.
R4	Several features are untested but are still in scope.
R5	Stakeholders demand last-minute UI changes.

Item No.	Mitigation Strategy	Bidding Starts At
M1	Hire external legal team to assess data compliance	\$3500
M2	Isolate unstable payment feature from MVP	\$2500
M3	Enforce code freeze on untested modules	\$2000
M4	Allow only minor UI tweaks with formal impact signoff	\$1500
M5	Introduce team wellness check-ins and reduce sprint WIP	\$1000
M6	Add automated test coverage for critical workflows (partial)	\$2000
M7	Conduct a dry-run deployment and rollback test	\$1800

Scenario 2

You only have \$10,000 in your risk budget.

Your product team is launching a **GenAI-powered resume screening platform** for a major recruiting firm. It's expected to go live within 2 weeks in a pilot with real candidate data.

At the last moment:

- 1. A news article questions the ethical fairness of your AI model.
- 2. The client asks for a **"gender-neutrality" audit** before go-live.
- 3. Your internal ethics team is unavailable due to a cybersecurity incident elsewhere.
- 4. The core AI model is producing **inconsistent results for multilingual resumes**.
- 5. The business insists on going live to meet a demo commitment with their investors.

Risk ID	Description
R1	AI bias accusation damages brand reputation
R2	Model fails to handle resumes in regional languages
R3	Gender fairness audit fails or is incomplete
R4	Cybersecurity incident drains internal audit resources
R5	Business pushes go-live regardless of risk readiness

Item ID	Mitigation Strategy	Start Price (\$)
M1	Hire external AI ethics consultant to conduct rapid audit	\$4000
M2	Temporarily disable multilingual support & flag it as known limitation in pilot	\$2000
M3	Conduct fairness checks using open-source gender de-biasing tool	\$2500
M4	Hold internal go/no-go meeting with legal + branding team	\$1000
M5	Add disclaimer for AI decisions in onboarding flow	\$1500
M6	Revert to earlier stable AI model trained only on English data	\$2000
M7	Engage external firm for short-term cyber advisory & backup compliance resource	\$3000

Scenario 3

You only have \$10,000 in your risk budget.

Your product and engineering team is migrating user data into a **new unified CRM** system as part of a company merger.

You have **6 weeks** to complete the migration, and stakeholders from both organizations are demanding **new features** and **dashboard redesigns** during the same period.

Unfortunately, the user data is **scattered, inconsistent**, and managed differently across platforms.

Meanwhile, leadership wants a **board-level demo** before the next quarter.

Risk ID	Description
R1	Data migration fails due to incompatible schemas
R2	Your top engineers are pulled off the project by HR post-merger
R3	Stakeholders insist on last-minute UI and analytics changes
R4	Analytics module causes duplication and misreporting
R5	Users experience downtime during CRM migration and start churning
R6	Board insists on live demo before system is ready

Item ID	Mitigation Strategy	Start Price (\$)
M1	Hire a data architect to create mapping & reconciliation plan	\$4000
M2	Secure written resource lock-in from HR	\$2000
M3	Implement a stakeholder change freeze until migration is complete	\$1500
M4	Isolate analytics module in sandbox environment	\$2500
M5	Prepare a staged cutover with rollback plan and downtime alerts	\$2000
M6	Create a pre-recorded product walkthrough for board demo	\$1800
M7	Use synthetic test data to validate migrated records across systems	\$1500